

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

- A. Being African or Hispanic American
- B. A lower level of education
- C. Living in a city
- D. Being married
- E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
- F. High intake of saturated fats
- G. Older age
- H. Eating fish
- I. Being a smoker
- J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

</tool_call> reasoning process here

Alzheimer's disease risk factors include age , genetics , education level , diet , and lifestyle . Let's evaluate each option :

- A . Being African or Hispanic American â This is associated with higher risk due to socioeconomic and healthcare disparities , not decreased risk .
- B . A lower level of education â Lower education is linked to increased risk , as cognitive reserve is often reduced .
- C . Living in a city â Urban living is not consistently linked to decreased risk ; some studies suggest possible increased risk due to pollution or stress .
- D . Being married â Married individuals often show lower risk of dementia due to social engagement , emotional support , and healthier lifestyles . This is a well-documented protective factor .
- E . Having a family history of Alzheimer's â Strong genetic link ; increases risk .
- F . High intake of saturated fats â Associated with increased risk due to cardiovascular issues .
- G . Older age â The strongest risk factor ; risk increases with age .
- H . Eating fish â Fish , especially fatty fish rich in omega - 3 fatty acids , is associated with reduced risk of Alzheimer's due to anti-inflammatory and neuroprotective effects .
- I . Being a smoker â Smoking increases risk due to vascular damage and inflammation .
- J . Drinking alcohol regularly â Excessive drinking increases risk ; moderate drinking may have some protective effects , but not consistently proven and can be harmful in excess .

Among the options , both D (being married) and H (eating fish) are associated with reduced risk . However , the question asks for the factor most directly associated with decreased risk . Research shows that social engagement and marriage (D) is a strong , independent protective factor . Fish consumption (H) is also protective , but the evidence is more tied to diet and nutrients .

However , among the listed options , " being married " is one of the most consistently supported non-pharmacological protective factors in epidemiological studies .

Therefore , the best answer is D .

< answer >D < /answer >